

Ecclesiastical Latin

EL-III.5: Lessons and Epistles: Argument on the Page

Recover a connected reading's argument, quotation levels, temporal relations, and exhortative movement directly from its Latin connectors and clauses

Stage	Stage III — Independent Missal Reading
Prerequisite	EL-III.4 and reliable analysis of multi-clause prose
Next	EL-III.6, Gospels

Read *EL-GUIDE: Start Here* before using this packet. Course method, pacing, source conventions, and answer protocol are stated there; this module begins with its lesson and assumes previously taught terms.

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Part I

Lesson

CHAPTER 1

Lessons and Epistles: Argument on the Page

On completing this unit, you can:

- map argument markers and pronoun reference in Vulgate prose;
- construe indirect statement, participial chains, and biblical idiom;
- summarize a lesson's logical movement before translating individual words.

The liturgical heading *Lectio Epistolæ beati Pauli Apostoli* is not part of Paul's sentence. Likewise *Fratres* is a liturgical vocative added or retained at the reading's opening. Mark such frames before tracing an argument. Then circle *enim*, *autem*, *ergo*, *itaque*, *igitur*, *quoniam*, *sicut*, and *sed*. These small words reveal the skeleton that freer word order hides.

A **Lesson** is a proclaimed scriptural reading; an **Epistle** is a Lesson presented under an epistolary heading or drawn from an apostolic letter. The label does not change the quoted passage's grammar. An **argument** is an ordered movement from grounds through relations such as contrast or inference to a claim or exhortation. An **argument connector** is a word that signals one of those relations: a reason supports a claim, a contrast sets opposed members against each other, and an inference presents a conclusion as following from what precedes.

1.1 Exhortation built on time

Fratres: Scientes quia hora est iam nos de somno surgere. Nunc enim propior est nostra salus, quam cum credidimus. Nox præcessit, dies autem appropinquavit. Abiciamus ergo opera tenebrarum, et induamur arma lucis.

Source: *Missale Romanum* (1962), Dominica I Adventus, Epistola (Rom. 13:11–12).

scientes agrees with the implied plural addressees and introduces the reason for the exhortation. After *hora est*, the accusative-infinitive phrase *nos ... surgere* states what it is time for. Comparative *propior* agrees with *salus*; *quam cum credidimus* compares the present with the time when belief began. The paired perfects establish the new situation; *abiciamus* and passive *induamur* are hortatory subjunctives. *opera tenebrarum* and *arma lucis* make the ethical contrast concrete.

1.2 Tradition received and handed on

A **participial phrase** consists of a participle with its complements and modifiers. Because a participle is verbal but agrees adjectivally with a noun or pronoun, its agreement identifies its participant while its tense normally expresses time relative to the governing verb, not an independent absolute date.

Ego enim accepi a Domino quod et tradidi vobis: quoniam Dominus Iesus, in qua nocte tradebatur, accepit panem, et gratias agens fregit.

Source: *Missale Romanum* (1962), In Cena Domini and In festo Sanctissimi Corporis Christi, Epistola (1 Cor. 11:23–24).

The neuter relative *quod* is simultaneously what Paul received and what he handed on. The dative *vobis*

belongs to *tradidi*. In *in qua nocte*, *qua* is a relative adjective agreeing with *nocte*; no separate antecedent is printed: “on which night.” Imperfect passive *tradebatur* and perfect active *accepit* deliberately place betrayal and gift together. *gratias agens* is a present participial phrase whose action accompanies and precedes *fregit*.

1.3 A difficult indirect statement

Hoc enim sentite in vobis, quod et in Christo Iesu: qui cum in forma Dei esset, non rapinam arbitratus est esse se æqualem Deo: sed semetipsum exinanivit, formam servi accipiens.

Source: *Missale Romanum* (1962), Dominica II Passionis seu in Palmis, Epistola (Phil. 2:5–7).

The imperative *sentite* asks for the disposition that is also in Christ; *quod* supplies the comparison’s content. Concessive or circumstantial *cum ... esset* frames the main contrast. With *arbitratus est*, the indirect statement is *se esse æqualem Deo*: *se* is its accusative subject, *æqualem* predicate accusative, and *Deo* dative after *æqualis*. *rapinam* is the predicate complement of what he did not judge equality to be. The adversative *sed* turns to *semetipsum exinanivit*; *formam* is the object of participle *accipiens*.

1.4 Argument-map notation

In the margin write **R** for reason, **C** for contrast, **I** for inference, and **E** for exhortation. A useful summary is not yet a translation: “R: the hour has arrived; C: night/day; I/E: discard/put on.” This prevents a long English sentence from concealing the Latin logic.

An **argument map** records relations among propositions without replacing their wording. A **proposition** is the content asserted, denied, commanded, or entertained by a clause; several clauses may cooperate in one step of an argument, and one sentence may contain several propositions.

Part II

Practice

CHAPTER 1

Transfer, retrieval, and application

1.1 Exhortation built on time — transfer practice

Connection. Temporal forms often create the premise from which an exhortation follows.

Transfer task. On Worksheet III.17's reading, place every finite form on a past/present/future-or-response line and draw the connector that turns description into exhortation.

Retrieval check. Identify which mood, not an English helper verb, marks the communal response.

1.2 Tradition received and handed on — transfer practice

Connection. A reported tradition contains nested speakers, actions, and time relations.

Transfer task. Using the lesson's already printed institution narrative, make a three-level ledger for narrator, reported speaker, and quoted or enacted content.

Retrieval check. For one infinitive or relative clause, name its controller and relative time.

1.3 A difficult indirect statement — transfer practice

Connection. Accusative forms in indirect statement must be tested as subjects and predicates before they are called objects.

Transfer task. Take the lesson's difficult example, bracket the infinitive construction, and label controller, accusative subject, predicate or complement, and relative time.

Retrieval check. State why converting every accusative into a direct object destroys the construction.

1.4 Argument-map notation — transfer practice

Connection. A compact notation is useful only when another reader can reconstruct the evidence behind every arrow.

Transfer task. Turn one selected worksheet paragraph into six numbered propositions joined by labeled arrows; cite the Latin connector or mood beside every arrow.

Retrieval check. Mark one relation that context supplies without a dedicated conjunction.

Part III

Worksheets

CHAPTER 1

Unit III.5: Lessons and Epistles

Worksheet III.17 — Variant A

Worksheet ID: III.17

Focus: Advent argument map

Use: Label reason, contrast, inference, exhortation.

1. **Text:** *Scientes quia hora est iam nos de somno surgere. Nunc enim propior est nostra salus, quam cum credidimus. Nox præcessit, dies autem appropinquavit. Abiciamus ergo opera tenebrarum, et induamur arma lucis.*

Passage ID: III.17.1; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.

Map the argument and all non-indicative forms.

-
2. Explain *hora est nos surgere*.

-
3. Why is *propior* nominative feminine singular?

-
4. Contrast the voices of *abiciamus* and *induemur*; name each object/complement.

-
5. Answer in Latin: *Cur opera tenebrarum abicienda sunt?*

-
6. Write a four-line argument summary using only Latin nouns and infinitives.
-

Worksheet III.20 — Variant D**Worksheet ID:** III.20**Focus:** Prophetic lesson and unseen logic**Use:** Begin with the imperatives.

1. **Text:** *Surge, illuminare, Ierusalem: quia venit lumen tuum, et gloria Domini super te orta est. Quia ecce tenebrae operient terram, et caligo populos: super te autem orietur Dominus.*

Passage ID: III.20.1; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.

Map commands, reasons, contrasts, and future forms.

-
2. Why is *illuminare* an imperative rather than infinitive?

-
3. Distinguish *orta est* from *orietur*.

-
4. Resolve the subjects and ellipsis around *operient*.

-
5. Answer in Latin: *Quid super Ierusalem ortum est, et quis orietur?*

-
6. Give a four-step logic map.
-

Part IV

Assessment

CHAPTER 1

Mastery assessment and record

Advance when: Map a fresh connected reading into claims, grounds, contrasts, inferences, quotations, and exhortations; account for every finite and non-finite form; and summarize the argument without following a published translation.

Complete the assessment before opening the answer part. Record evidence, not confidence or elapsed time.

Evidence	First attempt	Delayed check
Date and conditions		
Worksheet ID and score		
Mastery task and result		
One recurring error family		
Correction stated as a rule		
Unseen or remediation item used		

If the criterion is met: continue to EL-III.6, Gospels.

If it is not met: Worksheets III.18 and III.19 remain optional tradition-narrative and indirect-statement practice.

Advance / remediate decision: _____ **Next review date:** _____

Reason in one complete sentence: _____

Part V

Answer Key

Open this part only after completing the assessment record. Use the comparison and alternative-answer protocol in EL-GUIDE.

CHAPTER 1

Practice models and rubrics

Exhortation built on time — model and rubric

Model / acceptable evidence. The model separates completed circumstance, present condition, and hortatory subjunctives, then cites the inference or transition marker. A timeline without clause force is incomplete.

Tradition received and handed on — model and rubric

Model / acceptable evidence. A passing ledger never assigns a reported action to the narrator merely because the nouns are nearby; every level cites a finite governor, quotation boundary, or relative antecedent.

A difficult indirect statement — model and rubric

Model / acceptable evidence. The model attaches the full accusative-infinitive unit to its governing verb and distinguishes its internal subject from any object. It gives the infinitive's time relative to the controller.

Argument-map notation — model and rubric

Model / acceptable evidence. Each node states one proposition; arrows name relations such as reason, contrast, inference, or command. An implicit relation is accepted only when its sequence and clause force are explained rather than asserted.

CHAPTER 2

Unit III.5: Lessons and Epistles

Solution III.17 — Variant A

Worksheet ID: III.17

Focus: Advent argument map

Use: Label reason, contrast, inference, exhortation.

1. **Text:** *Scientes quia hora est iam nos de somno surgere. Nunc enim propior est nostra salus, quam cum credidimus. Nox præcessit, dies autem appropinquavit. Abiciamus ergo opera tenebrarum, et induamur arma lucis.*

Passage ID: III.17.1; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.

Map the argument and all non-indicative forms.

Answer / notes: R: *scientes quia hora est ... surgere*; R introduced by *enim*: salvation nearer; C: night passed/day approached; I/E with *ergo*: hortatory *abiciamus, induamur*. *nos* is accusative subject of infinitive *surgere*; *cum credidimus* is temporal comparison.

2. Explain *hora est nos surgere*.

Answer / model: *hora est* introduces what it is time for; *nos* is accusative subject and *surgere* present active infinitive in an accusative-infinitive content phrase.

3. Why is *propior* nominative feminine singular?

Answer / model: It is a comparative adjective agreeing with feminine singular subject *salus*.

4. Contrast the voices of *abiciamus* and *induamur*; name each object/complement.

Answer / model: *abiciamus* active with object *opera tenebrarum*; *induamur* passive, with accusative of thing put on *arma lucis* in the biblical construction.

5. Answer in Latin: *Cur opera tenebrarum abicienda sunt?*

Answer / model: *Opera tenebrarum abicienda sunt quia nox præcessit et dies appropinquavit.*

6. Write a four-line argument summary using only Latin nouns and infinitives.

Answer / model: Model: *Hora surgendi. Salus propior. Nox præterita, dies appropinquans. Opera abicere et arma lucis induere.*

Solution III.20 — Variant D

Worksheet ID: III.20

Focus: Prophetic lesson and unseen logic

Use: Begin with the imperatives.

1. **Text:** *Surge, illuminare, Ierusalem: quia venit lumen tuum, et gloria Domini super te orta est. Quia ecce tenebræ operient terram, et caligo populos: super te autem orietur Dominus.*

Passage ID: III.20.1; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.

Map commands, reasons, contrasts, and future forms.

Answer / notes: Commands *surge, illuminare*, vocative *Ierusalem*. First *quia*: perfect *venit* with subject *lumen*; *gloria ... orta est* perfect deponent. Second reason: future *operient* with subject *tenebræ* and object *terram*; strict parallel supplies *caligo [operiet] populos*. Adversative *autem*: future deponent *orietur*, subject *Dominus*. Source: In Epiphania Domini, Lectio (Is. 60:1–2).

2. Why is *illuminare* an imperative rather than infinitive?

Answer / model: It is the second singular present passive imperative of active *illumino, illuminare*, literally “be illumined,” coordinated with *surge*; the final *-re* is the regular present passive imperative ending.

3. Distinguish *orta est* from *orietur*.

Answer / model: Both from deponent *orior*: third singular perfect (has arisen) and third singular future (will arise).

4. Resolve the subjects and ellipsis around *operient*.

Answer / model: Plural *tenebræ* is the subject of plural *operient*, with object *terram*. In the balanced second member, singular *caligo* is subject and *populos* object; supply singular *[operiet]* from strict parallel rather than making *caligo* agree with the printed plural verb.

5. Answer in Latin: *Quid super Ierusalem ortum est, et quis orietur?*

Answer / model: *Gloria Domini super Ierusalem orta est, et Dominus super eam orietur.*

6. Give a four-step logic map.

Answer / model: E: arise/be illumined; R: light and glory have arisen; R/C: darkness will cover earth/peoples; C/promise: the Lord will arise over Jerusalem.

Part VI

Scope and Sources

CHAPTER 1

Scope and Qualifications

1.1 Packet boundary

This is module EL-III.5, *Lessons and Epistles: Argument on the Page*, in Triptych's print-first Ecclesiastical Latin curriculum. It imports one authoritative lesson, transfer practice for its internal submodules, two selected worksheets, one local mastery assessment, and matching solutions. The two selected readings establish a reusable mapping process; they do not sample every scriptural author or lesson genre in the Missal.

The unprinted worksheet variants remain course-owned extension material; their omission is intentional and is not a claim that the module exhausts available practice. EL-GUIDE owns the course-wide study method, pacing, lookup discipline, answer protocol, source classes, and advancement rules; this packet assumes that orientation and terminology taught in prerequisite modules.

1.2 Controlling records and local state

Course-wide research records own the edition, passage, answer, curriculum, and source decisions; the leaf's module map records this packet's selection and transfer practice. EL-GUIDE owns the corpus, normalization, translation, non-authority, review, and answer conventions that apply here. Claim-local qualifications remain beside the affected material; check received wording against the course-wide passage inventory.

Any installed snapshot is a working study held from release until its exact bytes and outstanding distribution gates receive separate authorization.

CHAPTER 2

References

The following works are the course's controlling corpus and reference aids. Project-composed explanation, translation, analysis, exercises, and models are distinguished from received wording under the convention stated in the Scope and Qualifications appendix. Short source passages are identified so that the learner can verify their wider context. The adjacent edition manifest and passage inventory record exact source roles, checks, access states, and known rights limits.

2.1 Primary corpus

- Catholic Church, *Missale Romanum ex decreto SS. Concilii Tridentini restitutum, Summorum Pontificum cura recognitum*, editio typica (Rome, 1962). A searchable presentation of the edition is hosted by the Holy See's Biblia Clerus project: <https://www.clerus.org/bibliaclerusonline/EN/gmb.htm>.
- A page-image scan of the 1962 typical edition is available through the Church Music Association of America: <https://media.churchmusicassociation.org/pdf/missale62.pdf>. Page images, rather than unsourced transcriptions, should decide doubtful punctuation or spelling.

- The Clementine Vulgate is the principal biblical comparison corpus. The public-domain 1914 edition edited by Michael Hetzenauer and its provenance are described at <https://www.sacredbible.org/vulgate1914/>.

2.2 Grammar and lexicography

- J. H. Allen and J. B. Greenough, *New Latin Grammar for Schools and Colleges* (1903), a donor-declared public-domain reference whose digital locator was not independently consulted during integration: <https://archive.org/details/allengreenoughsn01alle>.
- Charles E. Bennett, *New Latin Grammar*, 1918 revision, Project Gutenberg eBook 15665; public-domain text in the United States: <https://www.gutenberg.org/ebooks/15665>.
- Charlton T. Lewis and Charles Short, *A Latin Dictionary* (1879), searchable transcription: <https://logeion.uchicago.edu/lexidium>.
- Charles du Fresne, sieur du Cange, *Glossarium mediae et infimae latinitatis*, a donor-declared later-vocabulary aid whose digital locator was not independently consulted during integration: <http://ducange.enc.sorbonne.fr/>.

The underlying 1903, 1918, 1879, and 1883–1887 printed works are public domain in the United States. Digital transcriptions and interfaces retain their own terms and are cited as access tools, not relicensed or reproduced wholesale. The 1962 Missal, Scripture, official text, and other received wording retain their own status; see the scope appendix, research records, and final-page rights notice.

Classical reference grammars describe the inherited system but do not by themselves explain every biblical or ecclesiastical development. The advanced volume therefore distinguishes classical baseline, Vulgate usage, later Christian usage, and stable liturgical formula instead of labeling every difference an “exception.”

2.3 Citation convention

Missal passages are cited by liturgical location and text genre rather than by a page number that varies among printings. Biblical texts are cited by book, chapter, and verse. Historical authors are cited by work and section wherever possible. A learner preparing a formal commentary should verify each passage against the edition actually being used and record any variant. These references are not a claim that every historical-linguistic question can be settled by the listed school grammars and dictionary interfaces.

CHAPTER 3

Generation Metadata

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Model: GPT-5-based Codex agent; unexposed: exact model identifier and model qualifiers

Agent/runtime: OpenAI Codex agents (curriculum architecture, module design, enrichment, source and answer audit, correction, production, and review); Codex CLI 0.144.6; API workspace; unexposed: server revision

Agent/runtime: OpenAI Codex agents (whole-curriculum structure audit, shared typesetting and selection correction, rendered-structure regression checks, production, and review); Codex CLI 0.144.6; API workspace; unexposed: server revision

Agent/runtime: OpenAI Codex agents (whole-curriculum Part-scoped numbering and rendered contents hierarchy correction, rendered contents-geometry regression checking, production, and review); Codex CLI 0.144.6; API workspace; unexposed: server revision

Agent/runtime: OpenAI Codex agents (starter-guide consolidation, module-flow and definition-retrieval revision, stage-boundary assessment correction, catalog and audit records, production, and review); Codex CLI 0.144.6; API workspace; unexposed: server revision

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